

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Anya Tique

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Anya Tique

Founding Curator Emerita

Anya remembers when the museum was two rooms and an argument. Anya helped build the Meridian's collection when the museum had more ambition than money and fewer committees than fire extinguishers.

- Hired **Artie Ficial** early in his career.
- Has known **Tess Tament** since **Tess** was a child.

ACTING TIPS

Imperious, funny, observant, utterly unimpressed by status. Age gives you permission to say what everyone else edits.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Anya Tique. I helped build this museum. Tonight I reserve the right to judge the lighting and everyone in it.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

INTRODUCTIONS

Anya Tique

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant planned to reveal that you accepted his first questionable donation in 1989 despite incomplete paperwork, staining the legacy you built.

Your other secret

You did approve that accession because the museum was desperate for funds and you convinced yourself the paperwork would follow.

Conversations to start

- Ask Artie Ficial whether the naming agreement preserves the museum you founded.
- Ask Tess Tament what she thinks Grant expects from his family tonight.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

HUNT FOR CLUES

Anya Tique

The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1** *The clue has chosen the place where ice cream refuses to melt.*
- 2** *Where fingers conduct a row of musical keys, a clue waits underneath.*
- 3** *Behind a crimson curtain, the museum has misplaced a document.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACT I: MOTIVE

Anya Tique

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

ACT I: MOTIVE

Anya Tique

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

I remember the institution before he discovered it. In 1989 I accepted one of Grant's early donations with incomplete paperwork. He planned to expose that tonight and stain the museum legacy I built. I should have demanded the missing documents then. He was making sure everybody would hear that now.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Anya Tique

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Anya Tique

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

At about 6:46 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to check the accession number on the side label rail. Some of us remember when this museum fitted in a smaller building. My old accession decision was not going to become his opening-night joke. I took an archive copy to his salon.

IF MURDERER

At about 6:46 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to open the sliding glass pane and read the accession card on the velvet shelf. Some of us remember when this museum fitted in a smaller building. I took an archive copy to his salon.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACT III: METHOD

Anya Tique

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

ACT III: METHOD

Anya Tique

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

The incomplete 1989 accession is mine. I approved it because the museum needed funds and convinced myself the promised papers would follow. They did not. Grant was about to make my old decision the story of this gala. I had hoped the institution might finally outlive my worst compromise.

Evidence Table / discovery index

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1. Gift agreement | 9. Education reallocation |
| 2. Shipping manifest / 1988 | 10. Donor Salon camera |
| 3. A warning left behind | 11. Donation entry / 1989 |
| 4. GRANT'S NIGHT OF GLORY | 12. Closing reveal / concept |
| 5. Treatment finding | 13. Display proposal / superseded |
| 6. Donor agreement / margin copy | 14. Clock inspection slip |
| 7. Auction result | 15. Cancelled programme cue |
| 8. Vincent Van Faux | 16. Grant Larceny's toast |



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACCUSATIONS

Anya Tique

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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COMING CLEAN

Anya Tique

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I approved the 1989 accession before its missing papers arrived. I changed the time of my inspection to cover that secret. The real job was to check the accession number on the side label rail. I did it before the curtain closed, not at the late time I gave you. The work was real; my timetable was dishonest. I did not poison Grant Larceny.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I remember the institution before he discovered it. In 1989 I accepted one of Grant's early donations with incomplete paperwork. He planned to expose that tonight and stain the museum legacy I built. I should have demanded the missing documents then. He was making sure everybody would hear that now. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.